Republican ticket and we both voted against him, of course—but he won.

That election, in fact, put the notorious Eightieth Congress into office, the first Congress in a quarter of a century to be dominated (narrowly) by the Republican Party. Truman had proven so inept in the eyes of the country that there were strong cries for his resignation, even from Democrats.

Heinlein seemed to me to be an ultraliberal all through the days of the Navy Yard, and so had Leslyn. Now I got a letter from Heinlein saying that it was his idea that Truman appoint a leading Republican as Secretary of State and then resign. The Republican would succeed to the presidency and would run the country with a Republican Congress. This was the first indication to me that he had grown conservative.

I disapproved of this suggestion that the Constitution be subverted and that the United States be converted into a parliamentary democracy, but I did not choose to quarrel over it. I answered with a short letter of bare disagreement.

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I had not entirely lost the knack of being rejected. Back in February 1942, Campbell had rejected "Victory Unintentional," and in the 4V2 years since, I had written eleven stories and sold them all.

Now I heard that Thrilling Wonder Stories was trying to improve the quality of its stories and was willing to pay $.02 a word, matching Astounding's rates. I raked through the barrel and found "Big Game/' which I had originally written as a Probability Zero story five years before. It was only a thousand words long, but I rewrote it, lengthened it to three thousand words, and called it "The Hunted." I sent it to Thrilling Wonder on October 30, 1946, and on November 9, it was rejected. I was rather devastated. My name had not yet become magic. It couldn't carry everything.

But it was really a pre-1942 story. I consoled myself with that and continued working on a new Foundation story, which I called "Now You See It—"

I got the news that same rejection day, in a letter from Leslyn, that Bob Heinlein had sold a science-fiction story to The Saturday Evening Post. In the 1930s, The Saturday Evening Post had been the Mecca and Paradise of all writers. Any beginner automatically sent his first miserable little brainchild to the Post, and anyone who got in at any stage in his career had Made It.

The cachet still lingered in 1946 and it was good that Bob had gotten in.